

UPSC Philosophy Optional Paper 1 Simulation

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

SECTION A - Western Philosophy

Q1 (COMPULSORY)

(a) "Percepts without concepts are blind and concepts without percepts are empty." In the light of this statement discuss how Kant reconciles rationalism with empiricism. [10 marks]

Model answer (183 words; practice model, not official): Kant's own formulation is: "Thoughts without content are empty, intuitions without concepts are blind" (A51/B75). The question paraphrases intuition as percept; its point is the reciprocal dependence of sensible content and conceptual form. The two halves. Thoughts without content are empty corrects rationalism: a concept for which no corresponding intuition is even possible determines no object. Intuitions without concepts are blind corrects empiricism: an unsynthesised manifold is not yet perception of an object, since without a rule there is nothing to be right or wrong about. The reconciliation. Human cognition has two stems: sensibility, receptive, supplying content under the forms of space and time, and understanding, spontaneous, supplying rules through the categories. "The understanding can intuit nothing, and the senses can think nothing." Knowledge is their union. This is not a fifty-fifty compromise. Kant sides with the empiricist about the source of content and with the rationalist about the source of necessity, which is possible only because he has separated the two questions. Verdict. The reconciliation is bought by restricting the categories to possible experience - so it is simultaneously an anti-metaphysical verdict.

(b) "An ostensive definition can be variously interpreted in every case." Examine the significance of this remark for Wittgenstein's account of meaning. [10 marks]

Model answer (165 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The remark denies ostension the office it had been given - connecting language to the world from outside every practice - and removes the last refuge of the referential model of meaning. The argument. 28 shows that pointing at two nuts while saying "This is called 'two'" leaves the lesson undetermined: the word might be taken for a number, a colour, a shape, a material or a proper name. 29-30 show that the obvious repair - "this number is called two" - borrows an understanding of "number", so that "one has already to know (or be able to do) something in order to be capable of asking a thing's name". The explanations do not terminate in a self-explaining item. The positive condition. 31 supplies it through the chess-king: being shown the piece and told "This is the king" teaches its use only to someone who knows the shape of a game. The definition works "when the place is already prepared", and training (5-6) and correction prepare it. Significance.

(c) "Ideas are timeless and spaceless." Elucidate this statement with reference to Plato. [10 marks]

Model answer (197 words; practice model, not official): Deriving the property. For Plato a Form (eidos, idea) is a non-material, self-identical universal - Beauty itself, not any beautiful thing. Two consequences follow directly. Being non-material, a Form has no magnitude, shape or position, so it is spaceless; the Form of Justice is not anywhere. Being self-identical, it cannot be generated, destroyed or altered, so it is timeless; it does not become more just or less just. Why it matters. Only what cannot be otherwise can be strictly known. Timeless and spaceless Forms are therefore the proper objects of knowledge (episteme), while spatio-temporal particulars, which both are and are not F, yield only opinion (doxa). This is the load-bearing link between Plato's epistemology and his metaphysics. Two cautions. "Intelligible realm" is a structural expression, not a second location - a spaceless entity cannot be somewhere. Nor are Forms concepts in minds, which would make the standard depend on the beings it corrects. Evaluation. The property is the theory's strength and its wound. What lifts Forms above flux also removes them from the spatio-temporal order they are supposed to explain, which is precisely Aristotle's charge at Metaphysics I.9 that separated Forms cannot cause change or account for generation.

(d) Distinguish Hegel's true infinite from the bad infinite, and explain why the distinction is required by Absolute Idealism. Discuss. [10 marks]

Model answer (192 words; practice model, not official): The bad infinite. A spurious infinite (schlechte Unendlichkeit) is one that stands beyond the finite in an endless "and so on". Its defect is structural: because it is defined by excluding the finite, the finite supplies its border, and whatever has a border is limited. An infinite reached by exclusion is therefore finite. The true infinite. The genuine infinite includes finite self-limitation and return within itself. The finite is real as a moment - neither annihilated nor left standing outside as an independent remainder. Why Absolute Idealism requires it. If the Absolute were one object over against finite objects, it would be exactly a bad infinite, and Hegel's whole position would collapse into the two-world picture he rejects in Kant. The distinction is what licenses the claim that the Absolute is not a thing behind the world but the world grasped as a self-developing whole, and it is also what secures the reality of appearance: a whole that annihilated its moments would have restored the exclusion it was meant to overcome. Verdict. The distinction is the logical control behind the system; whether the finite retains genuine irreducibility inside it remains the standing objection.

(e) Can hallucination be regarded as an intentional act by Husserl? Explain. [10 marks]

Model answer (193 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. Yes. On Husserl's account hallucination is a fully intentional act, and the reason exposes what intentionality is. The criterion. Intentionality, inherited from Brentano and transformed, is the thesis that every act of consciousness is consciousness of something. Its structure is the correlation of the noesis, the manner of intending, with the noema, the object precisely as intended. The criterion is directedness, not successful reference. The case. A hallucination has a perceptual-seeming noesis: it is lived in the manner of perceiving, not of imagining. It has a determinate noema - this shape, this colour, at this place, with unseen sides co-intended. Both members of the correlation are present. What is missing. Not structure but intuitive fulfilment. The empty intentions belonging to the object are not honoured, and the failure appears as disappointment when the further course of perception fails to concord. Ideas I 24 grounds cognition in ordinary givenness only within the limits in which it is given, so an unfulfilled intention is a legitimate object of description. Qualification. Saying yes does not make hallucination veridical. The veridical/non-veridical distinction is retained and re-described as a difference in fulfilment rather than in intentional form.

Q2

(a) "Kant's Transcendental Deduction is the strongest anti-sceptical argument in modern philosophy and rests on its weakest scaffolding." Critically examine. [20 marks]

Model answer (400 words; practice model, not official): The strength. The Deduction asks the sceptic to concede almost nothing: that his representations are his. Kant's premise is that "the I think must be able to accompany all my representations" (B131-2); otherwise something would be represented in me that could not be thought, and would be nothing for me. From that premise: combination "can never come to us through the senses", since sensibility is receptive and delivers a manifold but never its unity; every synthesis is an act of spontaneity. A manifold can belong to one consciousness only if combined in a determinate, repeatable way - that is, according to rules. Those rules are the categories, since a category just is the concept of a synthesis in accordance with a logical function of judgement. And an object is "that in the concept of which the manifold of a given intuition is united". Hence the categories are necessarily valid of every object of possible experience. This is anti-scepticism without a premise the sceptic can refuse. It simultaneously answers Hume, who sought the self among impressions and found none because the "I think" is a condition and not a content, and rational psychology, which converted the same formal unity into a substance. The weakness. The metaphysical deduction supplies the inventory: twelve categories read off twelve logical functions of judgement, on the premise that the understanding is a faculty of judging. Fichte, Hegel and later Kantians object that the derivation is artificial and the completeness claim rests entirely on the logic Kant inherited. Kant's defence - that the table of judgements is exhaustive and systematic, and that no more complete rival was offered - is a defence of the best available list, not a proof. Adjudication. The two are separable. The Deduction's strategy is that objectivity is a condition rather than a discovery; its inventory is a historical contingency. Strawson's austere reading detaches the strategy and preserves the result. There is a further dispute - whether the A and B versions argue differently or only differ in exposition - but it concerns route and emphasis rather than the core claim. Verdict. The statement is accurate as it stands. The argument survives the loss of the table; the table would not survive the loss of the argument. Its remaining cost is scope: the conclusion holds of objects as they can be given to us, so the Deduction secures objectivity within possible experience and leaves things in themselves untouched.

(b) "The Second Analogy defeats Hume at the level of entitlement but not at the level of knowledge." Examine this claim. [15 marks]

Model answer (300 words; practice model, not official): The claim's first half. Hume argued that no impression of necessary connexion is available, so the concept of cause is a product of custom. Kant grants the analysis and denies the conclusion. His master premise is that time itself cannot be perceived (A176/B219), so objective temporal relations must be established by rules found among appearances. The argument runs: apprehension is successive in every case; I nevertheless distinguish surveying a house, where the order is reversible and mine to choose, from watching a ship drift downstream, where it is irreversible. That difference cannot lie in succession itself, nor be read off unperceivable time; it lies in the necessity of the order, which requires a rule - "everything that happens presupposes something upon which it follows according to a rule" (A189). The concept of cause is therefore a condition of experiencing an objective event. The claim's second half. Kant never derives which causes operate. That bread nourishes, that this collision produces that motion, remain empirical discoveries. The Analogy secures the form of nature and leaves the content to science. Verdict. The claim is accurate. Kant wins the entitlement Hume denied and declines the knowledge Hume demanded - which is not an evasion but a consequence of separating form from content. Strawson calls the central transition a "non-sequitur of numbing grossness", since that the order of my perceptions is not up to me does not entail that the event is necessitated by a causal law; Guyer argues that at most some rule is required. Allison replies that Kant is describing the conditions under which a succession can be judged objective, and that only a causal rule can fix an irreversible position in one time. The restriction to appearances then follows: the same argument that defeats Hume forbids inferring a first cause of the world.

(c) "But could we also imagine a language in which a person could write down or give vocal expression to his inner experiences-his feelings, moods and the rest-for his private use?" Critically discuss the answer offered by Wittgenstein to this question. [15 marks]

Model answer (298 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. Wittgenstein's answer is that we could not, and the reason is not that such a language would be unshareable but that its words would have no standard of correct application. Where the remark begins. 243 first sets aside the case that is not at issue: human beings who speak only in monologue, whose language a researcher could learn. The question is then narrowed to words that "refer to what can only be known to the person speaking; to his immediate private sensations". The target is logical privacy - not a code, not soliloquy, not undisclosed feeling. The diary. 258 tests the proposal. The diarist associates "S" with a recurring sensation and gives himself "a kind of ostensive definition" by concentrating his attention. But the ceremony can only mean that it brings it about that he remembers the connection rightly - "and here we have no criterion of

correctness ... whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'." Since 202 has established that obeying a rule is a practice, and that thinking one obeys is not obeying, no rule has been created. The constructive variant. 270 completes the diagnosis. Suppose writing "S" coincides with a rise in blood pressure registered by a manometer: the sign now has a genuine use - and whether the sensation was identified rightly has become irrelevant. Whatever work the sign does is done by the public criterion. Two objections. Memory: public checking also uses memory. Reply: it uses memory plus something independent - a chart, a record, another speaker - whereas 265 compares the private check to buying several copies of the same newspaper. Crusoe: a solitary man could invent sensation-words. Reply: solitude is not logical privacy; whether an actual community is required remains disputed. Verdict.

Q3

(a) "We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise 'logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used." Explain the transition from early views of Wittgenstein to his later views on language and meaning with reference to this statement. [20 marks]

Model answer (396 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The statement's contrast is accurate in its direction and misleading in one respect: what the later Wittgenstein abandons is not an artificial language in favour of a natural one, but the demand that some single hidden structure explain how any expression means anything. What the early view actually held. The Tractatus - German 1921, bilingual 1922 - gives one general propositional form, sense through the depiction of a possible state of affairs, and a shared logical form that cannot be said but shows itself. Crucially, it does not disparage ordinary language: 4.002 and 5.5563 hold everyday propositions to be, just as they stand, in perfect logical order. The "ideal language" of the quoted statement is therefore best read as the demand for a general logical account of factual sense, not as a proposal to replace English. The pressures. Four, and cumulative. 23's list of countless language-games defeats one general form. 28-31 show that ostension explains a word only where the place is already prepared, so naming cannot ground meaning. Colour exclusion - "this spot is red" against "this spot is green" - strains the independence of elementary propositions and was acknowledged in "Some Remarks on Logical Form" (1929), though it is a pressure rather than a refutation. 47 shows that "simple" has sense only relative to a game. What "empirically" means. Not that philosophy becomes an empirical science. 109 replaces explanation with description, and 122 sets the goal as a perspicuous representation that lets us see connections. The investigation is of grammar, conducted by comparison (130-131). The later account. 43 states the thesis with its own limitation. 66-67 remove the essence-demand through family resemblance and the spun thread. 19 and 23 place language-games within a form of life, and 241-242 locate agreement in judgments rather than opinions. 201 shows that no interpretation fixes its own application, and 258 turns the result on the inner domain the referential model seemed to fit best. Verdict. The transition is from a theoretical to a therapeutic conception of philosophy: 309's aim is to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle. Its gain is release from the ideal-language model; its costs are the quietism 124 invites and an unresolved question about distinguishing correct use from innovation and error. Both books hold philosophy to be clarification, and both consume their own doctrine - the ladder at 6.54, the plural at 133.

(b) "The Categories and Metaphysics VII (Z) give different answers because they ask different questions." Critically examine this resolution of Aristotle's account of substance. [15 marks]

Model answer (286 words; practice model, not official): The apparent conflict. In the Categories (2a11 ff.) primary substance is the concrete individual - "this man", "this horse" (tode ti) - and species and genus are secondary substances said of it. In Metaphysics VII (Z) substance is the form or essence (to ti en eina), prior to the compound in being, definition and knowledge; matter is rejected as substance at Z.3; and Z.13 states bluntly that no universal is a substance, although form looks universal. The proposed resolution. The Categories asks which things are substances and answers by a logical-linguistic criterion: the ultimate subject of predication. Metaphysics Z asks what the substance of a thing is and answers by a causal-explanatory criterion, reformulated at Z.17 as "why is this matter a house?". Two different questions may have two different answers, and Aristotle insists that being is said in many ways. Critical examination. The resolution is the safest available and is textually well grounded. But it does not dissolve every difficulty. If form is the species-form, Z.13 generates a genuine aporia which Aristotle does not fully resolve - the reading associated with Owen. If form is individual in each substance - the Frede-Patzig line - the tension disappears but the universality science requires becomes harder to secure. Jaeger's developmental reading, that the Categories is early and Platonic-adjacent, depends on a chronology that is itself disputed. Verdict. The different-questions reading should be led with, because it explains Z.3's rejection of bare matter and Z.17's reformulation as steps in one enquiry rather than reversals. It should then be qualified: the individual remains what exists primarily, but what accounts for its being that individual is its form, and whether that form is individual or specific is still contested.

(c) Assess the view that Hegel's identification of the rational with the actual makes his philosophy a defence of the existing order. [15 marks]

Model answer (263 words; practice model, not official): The charge. The Preface to the Philosophy of Right declares that "what is rational is actual, and what is actual is rational". Read straightforwardly, this appears to certify whatever exists - and Hegel's own accommodation with the Prussian state has long been cited as evidence that he meant it that way. The technical reply. The sentence turns on actuality (Wirklichkeit), the effective unity of essence and existence - the realised operation of a concept - and not on bare determinate existence (Dasein). An institution can perfectly well exist without being actual, if it fails to realise the concept it claims to embody. Far from blocking criticism, the distinction supplies its standard: a defective institution is measured against the concept it does not realise. wirklich must be translated or glossed, since rendering it "existing" makes the sentence assert the opposite of Hegel's intention. What the reply does not settle. Two residues remain. First, the criterion is only as good as its application, and critics can reasonably ask whether Hegel applied it too gently to the modern constitutional state. Second, the same conservatism charge attaches to his philosophy of history, where a retrospective teleology can rationalise victors and understate contingency, colonialism,

class and gender exclusion. The actuality/existence distinction is a defence of the formula; it is not a defence of every use Hegel made of it. Verdict. The view is mistaken as a reading of the doctrine and not baseless as a reading of the man. The formula licenses immanent criticism; Hegel's own political conclusions remain contestable, and the honest answer says both in the same paragraph.

Q4

(a) Compare Plato's and Aristotle's metaphysics of form, and evaluate whether Aristotle's immanentism is an advance on Plato's transcendence. [20 marks]

Model answer (396 words; practice model, not official): Frame. Both use the word *eidos*; the dispute is whether form exists apart from its instances. Everything else - causation, generation, knowledge, substance - follows from that difference. Plato. Forms are eternal, non-material, self-identical universals, independent of sensible particulars and neither in space nor in time. They solve three problems at once: the unity of the many (*hen epi pollon*), knowledge amid flux, and the objectivity of value. Particulars are what they are by participation (*methexis*) or imitation (*mimesis*); the Form is paradigm, the particular imperfect copy. The Sun, Divided Line and Cave (Republic VI 507a - VII 517a) form one continuous argument in which degrees of cognitive clarity track degrees of being, with the Good giving the Forms knowability and being and itself said to lie "beyond being" (*epekeina tes ousias*) at 509b. For Plato true substance (*ousia*) is the universal. Aristotle. He inverts this. Primary substance is the concrete individual (*tode ti*); species and genus are secondary. Form is the immanent what-it-is-to-be (*to ti en einai*) of a composite (*synolon*); matter is relative and correlative to form. Change is analysed through subject, form and privation (*steresis*), explained by the four causes, and understood modally as passage from potentiality (*dynamis*) to actuality (*energeia*) - "the actuality of the potential as potential" (Physics III.1, 201a10). The system terminates in the Unmoved Mover, pure actuality moving as final cause (Metaphysics XII (.7)). The critique. At Metaphysics I.9 Aristotle charges Plato with duplicating the explananda, leaving participation a metaphor, rendering Forms causally impotent and offering no account of generation; the Third Man regress at Parmenides 132a-b adds a formal difficulty. Evaluation. Immanentism advances on three counts: it removes the regress by removing separation, makes form a genuine cause of this thing, and makes generation intelligible. It does not advance on a fourth: Plato's insight that intelligibility may require something beyond the particular is answered rather than refuted, and Metaphysics VII (Z).13's denial that any universal is a substance sets Aristotle a difficulty as deep as the Third Man. Nor is Plato as thin as Aristotle suggests: the *Timaeus* supplies a Demiurge ordering becoming after Forms and a Receptacle in which becoming appears, so the accurate charge is that separated Forms themselves explain neither motion nor organisation. Verdict. Aristotle transforms Plato's insight rather than erasing it. The dispute is converted into the problem of universals and every later realism-nominalism debate.

(b) Elucidate the significance of bracketing and reduction in Husserl's phenomenological method. [15 marks]

Model answer (271 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. Bracketing and reduction are significant because of three things they make possible, each of which would otherwise be lost. What is bracketed. Suspension (*epoche*) puts the general thesis of the natural attitude out of play: the existence-positing is neither affirmed nor denied. The bracket falls on a validity-claim, never on a content - the tree is still described as green, seen from this side, with unseen sides co-intended. What remains, the residue, is the whole field of pure experience, and it is wider than what the natural attitude records. Four operations, not one ladder. The phenomenological reduction leads inquiry back - *re-ducere* - from what is this object? to how is it given?; the eidetic reduction moves from the factual instance to its essence by free imaginative variation; the transcendental reduction asks for the constituting subjectivity for which sense and validity arise. Eidetic analysis already operates in the Logical Investigations (1900-01), before the transcendental turn of Ideas I (1913), so the operations must not be presented as fixed rungs. The three purposes. (i) Evidence under a changed attitude: the stream is apodictically unavoidable as experienced, though apodicticity is not exhaustive transparency and particular self-descriptions stay corrigible - precisely what Ideas I 24 requires by limiting evidence to what is given within the limits of its givenness. (ii) No substance-inference: consciousness is analysed as intentional life rather than established as a separate mental thing, which reformulates rather than dissolves the mind-body problem. (iii) Eidetic and transcendental questions become askable: only a field cleared of factual commitment can be varied for invariants; without this, phenomenology would be a diary of episodes - that is, empirical psychology. Limitation.

(c) Among the rationalists, whose account of mind-body problem is compatible with the notion of human freedom and free will? Critically discuss. [15 marks]

Model answer (262 words; practice model, not official): Compatibility depends on the criterion of freedom, so the criterion must be declared first. Descartes' interactionism separates unextended mind from a mechanically determined body, permitting a libertarian will that can affirm, deny or withhold assent. But Princess Elisabeth's objection of 1643 remains unanswered: no intelligible account explains causal commerce between substances sharing no property, and the pineal gland supplies only a location. Descartes' own reply - that the union is a primitive notion - preserves the phenomenon and abandons the mechanism. Spinoza dissolves interaction by making mind and body the same mode under Thought and Extension (Ethics II, P7). This is metaphysically economical, but it entails necessitarianism: freedom becomes adequate self-determination, and free will as alternative choice is expressly denied. It also abandons ordinary mental causation, since no idea moves a limb, so the economy is bought by revising the very experience the question begins from. Leibniz denies interaction because windowless monads unfold internally, and pre-established harmony coordinates the mental and bodily series. Rational action remains spontaneous, intelligent and contingent, because the actual world is one possible world chosen by God, so truths about action are certain but not absolutely necessary. If "free will" means the ability to do otherwise, Descartes wins - with an unintelligible causal theory. If it means responsible agency compatible with systematic determination, Leibniz offers the strongest account. Spinoza offers the deepest self-mastery but openly rejects free will. Verdict. Leibniz is the best-qualified answer, because his mind-body theory preserves internal agency and moral responsibility without Cartesian interaction - though it remains compatibilist rather than libertarian, and buys correspondence from God in advance.

SECTION B - Indian Philosophy

Q5 (COMPULSORY)

(a) Do these two sentences "Air does not have heat" and "Air is not fire" refer to the same type of absence or abhava, according to the Vaisesikas? Discuss. [10 marks]

Model answer (188 words; practice model, not official): No - the two sentences report different kinds of absence (abhava). "Air does not have heat." The locus is air, a substance; the counterpositive is heat, a quality (guna). The claim is that a quality does not, and will not, reside in this locus. In the Vaisesika scheme hot touch is the characteristic touch of fire, so its absence in air is not a contingent shortage but a permanent categorial one. This is absolute non-existence (atyantabhava) of heat with respect to air. "Air is not fire." Here the counterpositive is fire, another substance (dravya). The claim denies identity between two entities, not the residence of a quality in a locus. This is mutual non-existence (anyonyabhava), which is reciprocal difference - as in "a pot is not a cloth". The deciding test. Ask what the counterpositive is. If the missing item is a quality that could have qualified the locus, the absence is absolute. If it is another entity with which the locus might be identified, the absence is mutual. Sameness of grammatical subject does not entail sameness of absence; the classification is fixed by the counterpositive, not by the locus.

(b) "In Jainism the moral quality of an act is fixed by passion rather than by activity." Examine this claim with reference to the parameters of bondage. [10 marks]

Model answer (160 words; practice model, not official): The claim is accurate if stated with care. Karmic bondage is analysed under four parameters. Activity of body, speech and mind determines the type (prakrti) of karma bound and the quantity (pradesa) of matter bound. Passion determines the duration (sthiti) and the intensity (anubhaga) of its fruition. Since duration and intensity are the parameters that actually decide how heavily an act weighs on the future of the soul, the moral seriousness of an act tracks passion rather than mere movement. The doctrinal expression of this is the contrast between momentary bondage from passion-free activity and durable bondage from passion-coloured activity: a monk's careful walking binds only momentarily, while an angry act binds deeply. The claim must nevertheless be qualified. Activity is not morally irrelevant, since it fixes what is bound at all, and total cessation of activity belongs only to the fourteenth stage. The precise formulation is therefore that activity determines the karmic content while passion determines its karmic weight.

(c) Distinguish between pudgala-nairatmyavada and dharma-nairatmyavada with reference to Buddhist Philosophy. [10 marks]

Model answer (161 words; practice model, not official): Both are forms of no-self, differing in scope. Personal no-self (pudgala-nairatmya) denies a permanent, independent person (pudgala) behind experience. The person is a designation on the five aggregates, and no owner is found among or behind them. This is the minimum thesis shared across Buddhist traditions, and it is what the chariot analogy establishes. Phenomenon no-self (dharma-nairatmya) extends the same analysis to the constituent factors themselves, denying that any dharma possesses intrinsic nature (svabhava). The difference is therefore between the owner and the inventory on which the owner was denied. Early Buddhism and the realist Abhidharma schools accept the first while treating dharmas as ultimately real; Vaibhasika and Sautrantika are precisely such positions. Mahayana, and Madhyamika above all, presses the second, which is why dependence yields emptiness there but conditioned realism in the earlier schools. The distinction is one of philosophical scope, not of institutional affiliation, and it should not be converted into a contrast between Theravada and Mahayana as wholes.

(d) How does Bhatta's view of nature of word-meaning and sentential-meaning differ from Prabhakara's view? Critically discuss. [10 marks]

Model answer (198 words; practice model, not official): Both sub-schools face the problem of sentence-unity (ekavakyata) and accept the same three conditions for it: mutual expectancy (akanksa), semantic fitness (yogyata) and proximity (sannidhi). They differ over which unit is semantically primary. Kumarila holds connection-of-the-already-denoted (abhihitavayavavada). Each word first denotes its own meaning (padartha) through its denotative power (abhidha); sentence-meaning then arises through a further connecting operation, explained as indirect signification (laksana) or purport-power (tatparya-sakti). The word is primary and sentence-meaning derivative, and the two stages are logical rather than temporal. Prabhakara holds denotation-of-the-connected (anvitabhidhanavada). Words denote their meanings only as already connected with the other meanings in the sentence. His evidence is the learning situation (vyutpatti): a child hears an elder command "bring the cow," sees a younger person comply, and learns the words in their connected, action-guiding sense. Critically, each is charged with what the other explains. Kumarila is charged with positing an unobserved isolated-word stage and an extra operation in every sentence; he replies that the distinction is explanatory, not introspective. Prabhakara is charged with making a word mean differently in every sentence; he replies that recurrent connected uses yield stable competence. The verdict is complementary: Bhatta secures stable lexical meaning, Prabhakara contextual action-guidance.

(e) Explain the two senses of the Middle Path (madhyama pratipad) in Buddhism. Why is the doctrinal sense indispensable to the practical one? [10 marks]

Model answer (156 words; practice model, not official): The Middle Path operates in two registers. Practically, it rejects sensual indulgence and self-mortification, replacing both with the Noble Eightfold Path (aryastangamarga) grouped under wisdom (right view, right intention), ethical discipline (right speech, action, livelihood) and meditative discipline (right effort, mindfulness, concentration). The rejection is diagnostic: indulgence feeds craving, while mortification exhausts the practitioner without touching it. Doctrinally, it

rejects eternalism (sasvatavada) and annihilationism (ucchedavada), replacing both with dependent origination and conditioned continuity. The doctrinal sense is indispensable because the practical path is unintelligible without it. If a permanent self existed, training could not transform it, and the third Noble Truth would fail. If nothing continued, discipline could accumulate no result, and the fourth would fail. Only conditioned continuity - change without a permanent bearer, and continuity without annihilation - makes a path both necessary and effective. Both senses share one logic: Buddhism denies the hidden assumption common to each pair of extremes rather than choosing between them.

Q6

(a) Elucidate Naiyayikas account of fallacies of the middle term in relation to five characteristics of valid middle term. [20 marks]

Model answer (381 words; practice model, not official): Nyaya tests the middle term twice - positively, through five marks of a valid reason (hetu), and negatively, through five fallacies of the reason (hetvabhasa). They are one test read in two directions. The five marks. (1) Presence in the subject (paksadharmata): the reason occurs in the subject under consideration. (2) Presence in similar instances (sapaksa-sattva): it occurs where the property is known to hold. (3) Absence from dissimilar instances (vipaksa-asattva): it never occurs where the property is known to be absent. (4) Not contradicted (abadhita): the property is not defeated by a stronger instrument. (5) Not counterbalanced (asatpratipaksa): no equally strong counter-reason exists. The five fallacies, mapped. Irregular (savyabhicara / anaikantika) violates mark 3. The reason strays into dissimilar instances. Subtypes: too common (sadharana), occurring in both similar and dissimilar instances; too restricted (asadharana), confined to the subject so that no contrast class remains; inconclusive by over-width (anupasamharin), so wide that no contrast is available. Unproved (asiddha / sadhyasama) violates mark 1. Subtypes: locus-unproved (asrayasiddha), where the subject is unreal; form-unproved (svarupasiddha), where the reason is absent from the subject; pervasion-unproved (vyapyatvasiddha), where concomitance is unestablished, typically because a conditioning adjunct (upadhi) is present - as wet fuel is in the inference from fire to smoke. Stultified (badhita / kalatita) violates mark 4. The conclusion is defeated by a stronger instrument: fire cannot be inferred to be cold, because perception overrules it. Counterbalanced (satpratipaksa / prakaranasama) violates mark 5. An equally strong opposing reason establishes the contrary property, and the dispute deadlocks with neither side defeated on its own terms. Contradictory (viruddha) is the exception. It does not merely negate one mark; it inverts the concomitance that all five marks presuppose, so that the reason proves the opposite of the intended property - a reason offered for permanence establishing impermanence instead. Evaluation. The correspondence is systematic rather than accidental: because a valid reason is defined by five conditions, exactly five modes of failure are possible, with one of them operating at the level of the relation itself rather than at the level of a condition. The scheme's power nevertheless depends on the prior availability of similar and dissimilar instances, which is exactly what positive-only (kevalanvayi) and negative-only (kevalavyatireki) inferences lack - so the fallacy theory is at its strongest where both classes exist and requires careful handling elsewhere.

(b) Critically evaluate the logical and metaphysical status of Visesa in the context of Vaisesika Philosophy. [15 marks]

Model answer (259 words; practice model, not official): Metaphysical status. Ultimate particularity (visesa) is the seventh-category individuator residing only in eternal substances: the atoms of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of ether, time, direction, self and mind. Composite objects need no particularity, since parts, qualities, place and causal history already distinguish them. Particularity is imperceptible and is known inferentially. It gives the Vaisesika school its name, so the system's identity is bound to it. Logical status. The posit answers a specific argument. Two atoms of earth may share every universal and every ordinary quality. If nothing further distinguished them, then by the identity of indiscernibles they would be one, and the school's pluralism would fail at its foundation. Particularity is introduced as the differentiator, and Nyaya frames the introduction inferentially - plurality of exactly similar eternal is otherwise inexplicable - which is consistent, since Nyaya reduces postulation (arthapatti) to inference rather than admitting it as a separate instrument. Two objections. First, the regress of differentiators: if particularity differentiates atoms, what differentiates particularities? The reply is that they are self-differentiating (svato-vyavartaka), distinguishing both their loci and themselves. Second, the charge of an imperceptible ontological IOU: an unperceived entity posited solely to perform one job. Evaluation. The replies are coherent but terminal rather than demonstrative. "Self-differentiating" names the stopping point instead of proving it, and every relational or individuating ontology must stop somewhere. The fair verdict is that particularity is logically indispensable within Vaisesika pluralism and metaphysically stipulative, which is why Jaina, Buddhist and Advaita critics - Sriharsa systematically - treat it, with inherence, as the school's weakest joint.

(c) "Jaina non-violence is a metaphysical consequence, not a sentiment." Critically discuss with reference to the doctrine of the soul and the mechanics of bondage. [15 marks]

Model answer (255 words; practice model, not official): The claim is well founded. Jaina non-violence (ahimsa) is derived, not asserted. The derivation begins in ontology. Souls are innumerable and graded from one-sense immobile beings - earth-, water-, fire-, air- and plant-bodied - to five-sense mobile beings. Every one of them is a conscious substance intrinsically endowed with the infinite tetrad and currently obscured. Injury therefore falls on a knower, not on a thing. It continues in the mechanics of bondage. Injury is characteristically produced by passion, and passion fixes the duration and intensity of karmic adhesion. Violence is thus not merely wrong by a rule; it is causally the most efficient way to deepen bondage. Non-violence, conversely, is an operation of stoppage: it closes the channel through which the heaviest karma enters. The doctrine is graded rather than utopian. Ascetics take the great vows; householders take the lesser vows; and carefulness in movement, speech, alms-seeking, handling objects and bodily functions extends the principle into ordinary conduct. Extreme care toward one-sense beings is an implication of the ontology, not an excess of feeling. Critically, two points deserve statement. First, the derivation is only as strong as its premises: a critic who denies that plants or elemental bodies house souls will accept the ethics while rejecting its scope. Second, the account is intention-sensitive

rather than consequence-sensitive, which is a philosophical choice with costs of its own. Nevertheless, the central contention holds: Jaina non-violence follows from plural souls and karmic mechanics, and treating it as sentiment removes precisely the argument that makes it distinctive among Indian ethical positions.

Q7

(a) 'Brahma satyam jaganmithya, Jivo Brahmaiva naparah'. In the light of this statement explain the ontological status of Isvara, Jiva and Saksi as elucidated in Advaita Vedanta. [20 marks]

Model answer (376 words; practice model, not official): The quoted line compresses Advaita into three claims: ultimate reality is real, the world is dependent appearance, and the individual self is none other than ultimate reality. It is a traditional Advaita summary rather than one of the four standard Upanisadic great sentences, and saying so is itself a mark of textual discipline. Read as a thesis, it fixes the status of all three terms asked. The Lord (isvara). The Lord is ultimate reality conditioned by indescribable illusion (maya-upahita brahman), the omniscient, omnipotent creator and moral governor of the empirical world. His status is therefore fully real at the empirical level (vyavaharika) and sublated at the ultimate level (paramarthika). Theism in Advaita is thus neither false in a crude sense nor final in the last sense - which is exactly the point at which Ramanuja objects that devotion is made provisional. The individual self (jiva). The individual is ultimate reality limited or reflected in ignorance together with the internal organ, appearing as doer, enjoyer and transmigrator. Its status is empirical bondage. Advaita explains the appearance three ways: limitation (avaccheda-vada, pot-space), reflection (pratibimba-vada, the mirrored face) and semblance (abhasa-vada), which stress plurality, vividness and ontological thinness while agreeing that individuality lacks ultimate reality. The second clause of the verse is thus literal: the individual is "none other than" the absolute in essence. The witness (saksi). The witness is pure witnessing consciousness - unaffected, immediate, self-luminous (svayam-prakasa) and non-objectifiable. It illumines all mental states without being altered by them, and is supported by the three-state analysis, where the report "I slept peacefully; I knew nothing" presupposes continuity through deep sleep. Its status is closest to the ultimate standpoint, since it is the individual's own essential consciousness considered apart from adjuncts. The hierarchy. The three are not three substances but one consciousness under three descriptions: the witness closest to the ultimate standpoint, the individual in empirical bondage, and the Lord in cosmic-ordering empirical reality. The first clause of the verse fixes the world as dependently real (mithya) - sublatale, not wholly non-existent - and the whole scheme is intelligible only through the three levels of reality graded by sublation (badha). Critically, the elegance of the hierarchy is purchased by the cost the verse itself concedes: the Lord, and therefore devotion, cannot be final.

(b) Analyse the four schools of Buddhism as an argumentative escalation rather than as a classification. What does each successive position gain and lose? [15 marks]

Model answer (277 words; practice model, not official): The fourfold matrix is a philosophical doxography, and its explanatory value lies in the fact that each position is generated by an objection the previous one cannot absorb. Vaibhasika holds direct realism about external dharmas and affirms sarvam asti, that dharmas of past, present and future have some mode of existence. It gains a genuine object for every cognition and a real relation between a past act and its future fruit. It loses ontological economy and strains momentariness, since extending existence across the three times sits awkwardly with strict one-moment duration. Sautrantika answers by restricting full existence to the present. Since the object-moment has ceased when its cognition arises, cognition bears only the object's form (akara), from which the external object is inferred. It gains consistency with momentariness. It loses direct access, and now owes an account of why the inferred cause should correspond to the form it produces. Yogacara presses exactly there: if all that is ever given is the form, the external object performs no explanatory work. Representation-only (vijñaptimatra) gains economy, and explains order through store-consciousness (alaya-vijnana) and seeds (bija). It loses the easy explanation of intersubjective agreement, which must now be derived from shared karmic conditioning, and it exposes consciousness itself to the charge of reification. Madhyamika presses that charge: even consciousness lacks intrinsic nature. Emptiness gains complete freedom from reification, including the emptiness of emptiness. It loses any positive ultimate, and must defend a non-implicative negation (prasajya-pratisedha) against the objection that denying all four corners either says nothing or refutes itself. Read as an escalation, the four schools display one method - remove whatever the analysis shows to be unnecessary - applied with increasing severity.

(c) Discuss the debate between the Bhatta and the Prabhakara mimamsakas with reference to the nature of Non-existence (Abhava) and its knowledge. [15 marks]

Model answer (296 words; practice model, not official): The debate is intra-Mimamsa and runs on two connected questions: what absence (abhava) is, and how it is known. Kumarila Bhatta treats absence as real. It is not a feature of language but a structured content determined by its counterpositive (pratiyogin), so that "absence of pot" has genuine ontological standing and negative cognition has a genuine object. Correspondingly, he admits a sixth instrument, non-cognition (anupalabdhi), defined as non-apprehension of what would be apprehended if present and limited by fitness (yogyata): the object must be perceptible in kind, the locus suitable, the organ functioning, and light, distance and attention proper. His reasons are two refusals. Perception yields positive content - table, colour, shape - whereas "absence of pot" is not a positive datum of that kind, so perceiving the empty table is not yet cognising the pot's absence. Inference needs a positive sign and a known concomitance; if "not-seeing" is offered as the sign, its evidentiary force already presupposes non-apprehension under fit conditions, so the reduction is strained or circular. Prabhakara declines both the ontology and the instrument. What is known, he holds, is simply the locus as unqualified by the absent object: we perceive the table as bare, not as occupied by the pot, and the bare-locus cognition already carries the negative differentiation required. No special faculty for what is not there need be posited. His position is an economy thesis, not a denial that absences are known. Kumarila's counter is that economy purchased by flattening a determinate negative judgement into a positive perception is false economy. For comparison, Nyaya converges with Prabhakara against Kumarila on independence while diverging in its reason,

since it holds that absence is itself directly perceived. The graded verdict is that Kumarila is the more faithful phenomenologist and Prabhakara the more economical metaphysician.

Q8

(a) How do the Naiyayikas prove the existence of God? Do the Yoga philosophers prove God in the same way? If yes, how? And if no, why? Give reasons for your answer. [20 marks]

Model answer (354 words; practice model, not official): The Nyaya proofs. Later Nyaya affirms God (Isvara) as an eternal, omniscient, bodiless special self who is the efficient cause (nimitta-karana) of the world but never its material cause; atoms remain the material cause. Udayana's Nyayakusumanjali presents converging inferences. From effect (karyat): the world is composite and ordered, hence an effect, hence requires an intelligent maker, as a pot requires a potter. From combination (ayojanat): at the start of a cycle, unconscious atoms and unconscious unseen moral force (adrsta) cannot initiate ordered first motion, so an intelligent impeller is required. From sustenance (dhrtyadeh): the cosmos is maintained, regulated and dissolved, which indicates governing intelligence. From scripture (sruteh): Vedic authority of superhuman scope implies an omniscient source. A moral strand is added: unconscious adrsta cannot allot fruits with precision, so an intelligent administrator is required. Whether Yoga proves God in the same way - no. Classical Yoga's God is a special conscious witness (purusa-visesa) untouched by afflictions, actions, fruits and latent deposits. He is admitted within an already complete soteriology of bondage and release, not inferred as the explanation of cosmic order. His role is practical: devotion to God (Isvara-pranidhana) aids concentration and meditative absorption, and he functions as the beginningless teacher. The Yoga-sutra does not construct Udayana's atomic creator inference, and Samkhya, Yoga's metaphysical partner, dispenses with a creator altogether. The reason for the difference. The two theisms answer different questions. Nyaya needs God because its atomism leaves a gap - inert atoms plus an unconscious moral ledger cannot start themselves - and because its realism about moral order requires an intelligent allocator. Yoga needs God because its practice requires an object of devotion and a guarantor of the possibility of perfect isolation. Argumentative role, not description, is the discriminating factor. Qualified verdict. Both systems accept God, but sameness of name does not prove sameness of demonstration or function. Later Yoga commentators may strengthen theistic cosmology; the safe conclusion is that classical Yoga's God is a soteriological posit and an object of practice, whereas Nyaya's is the conclusion of a cumulative natural theology whose every strand rests on the contested premiss that order and meaning require intelligence.

(b) Examine the Jaina claim that ordinary sense-perception is only conventionally direct. What does this reveal about the relation between Jaina epistemology and Jaina soteriology? [15 marks]

Model answer (259 words; practice model, not official): Jainism divides valid knowledge into direct (pratyaksa) and indirect (paroksa), but measures directness by absence of mediation rather than by sensory vividness. Ordinary sense-perception depends on sense-organs, the mind, signs and karmic limitation. It is therefore only conventional direct knowledge (samvyavaharika pratyaksa) and strictly belongs with mediated cognition. What is direct in the full sense is knowledge the soul has by itself: limited clairvoyance (avadhi), knowledge of others' mental modes (manahpariyaya) and omniscience (kevala). The claim is defensible on its own terms. It preserves ordinary life, since perception remains valid for practical dealings; it distinguishes practical adequacy from metaphysical finality; and it avoids the Nyaya assumption that sense-contact is the paradigm of directness. What it reveals is that Jaina epistemology is not a free-standing theory. The five kinds of knowledge are stations on a single curve of karmic unveiling: mati and sruta are mediated, the remaining three progressively direct, and omniscience is the state in which knowledge-obscuring karma has been destroyed. Knowledge is therefore graded by purity, not by method. Two consequences follow. First, conditional predication becomes obligatory rather than optional, because a ksayopasamika knower cannot make an unconditioned claim. Second, wrong cognition is orientation-relative: kumati, kusruta and vibhanga are cognitions held under wrong vision, so error is a spiritual as well as a logical category. Critically, this integration is the system's strength and its exposure. It gives Jainism a unified account of knowing and liberation, but it makes the epistemology depend on an ontology of soul and karmic matter that an empiricist critic will refuse at the outset.

(c) Explain the nature of God and its role in Kaivalya in yoga philosophy. [15 marks]

Model answer (263 words; practice model, not official): Yoga defines the Lord (Isvara) as a special conscious witness (purusa-visesa) untouched by affliction (klesa), action (karma), fruition (vipaka) and karmic deposit (asaya). In him lies the unsurpassed seed of omniscience; he is the teacher even of the ancients, being unconditioned by time; and he is denoted by the sacred syllable (pranava, OM), whose repetition with contemplation of its meaning is a canonical practice. He is special, not different in kind: he belongs to the category of conscious witness, and his distinction is that he was never entangled. This admission is what makes Yoga theistic Samkhya (sesvara-samkhya) against Samkhya's Godless tendency. His positive roles are five: object of meditation, aid through dedication (Isvara-pranidhana), remover of the nine obstacles (antaraya), perfect model of untouched status, and timeless teacher-principle anchoring transmission. His role in isolation (kaivalya) must be stated with precision. Isolation is the aloneness of the witness from primordial nature and its evolutes, reached through discriminative discernment (viveka-khyati), matured by higher dispassion (para-vairagya) and consummated in cloud-of-dharma absorption (dharmamegha-samadhi), after which the constituent qualities undergo involution (pratiprasava) and consciousness abides in its own nature. The Lord assists this process by stabilising the mind-field and clearing obstacles, but he does not grant isolation as an external gift. Four negations therefore complete the answer: he is not the material cause; he is not the Nyaya creator and efficient cause of the world-order; he is not a saviour who bestows liberation arbitrarily; and he is not a substitute for discernment. The exact formula is that the Lord is instrumental, not constitutive, in liberation - not redundant, but non-final.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS